

Name	Similarities	Differences
Da Ji (Herba seu Radix Cirsii Japonici)	Cool blood to stop bleeding	Stops bleeding, disperses blood stasis; reduces swelling for skin issues
Xiao Ji (Herba Cirsii)		Stops bleeding, promotes urination; eliminates toxicity, reduces swelling for skin issues
Di Yu (Radix Sanguisorbae)		Astringent, Stops lower <i>jiao</i> bleeding; clears heat, eliminates toxicity, generates flesh and promotes healing for burns
Bai Mao Gen (Rhizoma Imperatae)		Promotes urination; clears heat in the Lung and Stomach
Huai Hua Mi (Flos Sophorae)		Treats bleeding in the lower Jiao; lowers blood pressure
Qian Cao (Radix Rubiae)		Invigorates blood, disperses blood stasis, stops bleeding without causing blood stasis
Xian He Cao (Herba Agrimoniae)	Astringent to restrains leakage of blood and stops bleeding	Stops diarrhea; kills parasites
Bai Ji (Rhizoma Bletillae)		Stops bleeding of Lung and Stomach ; reduces swelling & promotes generation of flesh for treating ulcer and chapped skin (used externally)
Ou Jie (Nodus Nelumbinis Rhizomatis)		Astringent, stops bleeding for treating vomiting or coughing blood; disperses blood stasis when used in unprocessed form
Ce Bai Ye (Cacumen Platycladi)		Astringent stops bleeding; cools the blood; treats hair loss (topical); dispels phlegm and stops cough
Pu Huang (Pollen Typhae)		Disperses blood stasis from chest or abdomen
San Qi (Radix Notoginseng)	Invigorate blood, disperse blood stasis, stop bleeding without causing blood stasis	Strongly stops bleeding and relieves pain for treating traumatic injuries
Ai Ye (Folium Artemisiae Argyi)	Warms the channels, stops bleeding	Warms the channels to stop bleeding, disperses cold and relieves pain

Herbs That Stop Bleeding

- Stop bleeding both internally and externally.
- Bleeding is a symptom that represents an underlying condition. While it is important to treat symptomatically and stop the bleeding, it is equally important to identify the underlying cause and treat it accordingly.

- Cool the blood and stop bleeding; they are often combined with heat-clearing herbs.
- Restrain blood and stop bleeding; they are often combined with tonic herbs.
- Invigorate blood and stop bleeding. Qi and blood-moving herbs are sometimes added to achieve maximum effectiveness.
- Warm the body and stop bleeding, interior warming, Spleen tonic, qi and blood tonic herbs are often added for the best result.

Dà Jì 大蓟 “big thistle”

- *Herba seu Radix Cirsii Japonici*
- English: Japanese thistle, cirsium
- Properties: sweet, cool
- Channels: Spleen, Liver

Actions and Indications

Actions: Cools the blood and stops bleeding

Indications: for reckless movement of hot blood with such symptoms as nosebleed, vomiting blood, blood in the urine or stool or uterine bleeding. Xiao Ji, Che Bai Ye

Actions: Disperses blood stasis, reduces swelling

Indications: for carbuncles, sores and swelling are caused by toxicity and blood stagnation. For this purpose, the fresh herb is preferred for topical use, it can be used internally.

Actions: Lowers blood pressure, treats jaundice

Indications: Da Ji has been used recently to reduce blood pressure and treat jaundice.

Main Actions:

- Cools blood, stops bleeding
- Disperses blood, reduces swelling

Dosage: 10-15 grams in decoction, with a maximum of 30 grams for dried Da Ji. Use up to 60 grams of fresh herb. Unprocessed herb is stronger to cool the blood, stop bleeding and reduce swelling.

Cautions: Because of its blood-invigorating function, Da Ji should be used with caution during pregnancy.

Xiǎo Jì 小蓟 “small thistle”

- *Herba Cephalanoplos segetum*
- English: small thistle, common cephalanoplos

- Properties: sweet, cool
- Channels: Liver, Heart

Actions and Indications

Actions: Cools the blood and stops bleeding; Promotes urination

Indications: primarily used for blood in the urine (this herb is not as strong as Da Ji)

- Mu Tong, Hua Shi, Pu Huang (xiao ji yin zi)

Actions: Eliminates toxicity, reduces swelling.

Indications: used internally or applied topically for carbuncles, sores and swellings. The fresh herb is the best.

Main Actions:

Cools blood and stops bleeding

Eliminates toxicity and reduces swelling

Dosage: 10- 30 grams of dried herb, 30-60 grams of fresh herb. Fresh Xiao Ji is stronger to eliminate toxins and is often used topically to treat toxic swellings.

Cautions: Use Xiao Ji with caution in patients with loose stools or deficiency and cold of Spleen and Stomach.

Review questions

- What are the properties (temperature) of Da Ji and Xiao Ji?
- What are the common actions and indications of Da Ji and Xiao Ji?
- What kind of bleeding do Da Ji and Xiao Ji often being used together?
- Compare Da Ji and Xiao Ji

Dì Yú 地榆

- *Radix Sanguisorbae Officinalis*
- English: burnet-bloodwort root, sanguisorba
- Properties: bitter, sour, slightly cold
- Channels: Liver, Large Intestine, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Cools the blood, astringent, stops bleeding

Indications: especially for bleeding in the lower burner due to heat in the blood, with such symptoms as blood in the stool, bleeding hemorrhoids, bloody dysenteric disorders, and excessive uterine bleeding

- Bleeding hemorrhoids, blood in stool: Huai Hua
- Profuse menstrual bleeding with bright red blood and dry mouth and lips due to heat in the blood: Sheng Di, Huang Qin Tan, Pu Huang

- Bleeding dysentery with rectal tenesmus, mucus, and lower abdominal pain: Huang Lian, Mu Xiang, Wu Mei

Actions: Clears heat, eliminates toxicity, astringent, promotes healing, and generates flesh

Indications: applied topically for sores, ulcers, and injuries from burns.

- Skin burns: mix Di Yu powder with sesame oil and apply topically.
- Carbuncles and sores without pus: apply the juice of Di Yu topically.
- Eczema or ulcerations with itching, redness, swelling, and discharge:
- For topical application as an herbal wash, cook Di Yu and Ku Shen.
- To use as a topically applied powder, mix Di Yu, Shi Gao, Ku Fan

Main Actions:

- Cools blood, stops bleeding
- Clears toxic heat, generates flesh

Dosage: 10-15 grams, with a maximum of 30 grams in herbal decoction; or 1.5 to 3 grams per dose of Di Yu, one to three times daily as an herbal powder or pills. Di Yu is commonly used both internally and topically.

Cautions:

Cold, sour, and astringent in nature, Di Yu should be used with caution in cases of bleeding caused by deficiency, cold, or blood stasis.

External use of Di Yu is generally considered safe. However, topical application of Di Yu is not recommended for burns involving a large area of the skin. In this case, excessive absorption of the herb (water-soluble hydrolytic tannins) may lead to overdose and liver toxicity, such as toxic hepatitis.

Review questions

- Properties of Di Yu (taste)
- Actions and indications of Di Yu
- It is used primarily for what kind of bleeding?
- It is used mainly for treating what kind of skin conditions?
- Cautions when using Di Yu

Bái Máo Gēn 白茅根

- *Rhizoma Imperatae Cylindrica*
- English: rhizome of woolly grass, Imperata
- Properties: sweet, cold
- Channels: Lung, Stomach, Bladder

Actions and Indications

Actions: Cools the blood and stops bleeding

Indications: for the reckless movement of hot blood with such symptoms as blood in the urine, vomiting blood, nosebleed and coughing blood.

- Especially used to treat bleeding in the upper body, such as nose bleeds or coughing blood: Xian He Cao
- Urinary bleeding: Che Bai Ye, Xiao Ji, Pu Huang

Actions: Clears heat and promotes urination.

Indications: for hot, painful urinary dribbling and damp-heat jaundice with edema and urinary difficulty: Che Qian Zi, Hua Shi Zhi Zhi, Yin Chen Hao

Actions: Clears heat from the Stomach and Lungs

Indications: for nausea and thirst due to Stomach heat, or wheezing due to Lung heat. It is often combined with Lu Gen

Main Actions:

- Cools blood and stops bleeding
- Clears heat (Lung, Stomach, Bladder) and promotes urination

Dosage: 15-30 grams of dried herb. The dosage for fresh Bai Mao Gen is 30-60 grams. The fresh herb has a stronger function to clear heat, cool blood and promote urination.

Review questions

- What is the temperature of Bai Mao Gen?
- Actions and indications of Bai Mao Gen
- Herb for nose bleeding, coughing out blood or vomiting blood.
- What herbs are used for blood in the urine due to heat?

Huái Huā 槐花

“pagoda flower”

Huai (Hua) Mi (Sophorae Flos immaturus)

- *Flos Sophorae Japonicae Immaturus*
- English: pagoda tree flower (bud)
- Properties: bitter, cool
- Channels: Liver, Large Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Cools the blood and stops bleeding

Indications: for various bleeding disorders characterized by heat in the blood. Huai Hua is most effective and most commonly used to treat bleeding in the lower Jiao.

- Bright red blood in stool, caused by damp-heat in the large intestine: Huai Hua, Di Yu Tan, Che Bai Ye, Fang Feng
- Bleeding hemorrhoids: Xian He Cao, Bai Mao Gen, Gan Cao
- Huai Hua also used for coughing of blood, nosebleed, or uterine bleeding.

- Huai Hua has been used recently to treat hypertension.

Main Actions:

- Cools blood, stops bleeding

Dosage: 10-15 grams. Fresh herb has stronger function to cool blood and lower blood pressure.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Huai Hua.
- Where does Huai Hua stop bleeding more effectively?

Cè Bái Yè 侧柏叶 “flat fir leaves”

- *Cacumen Biotae Orientalis* (dried leaves of *Platycladus orientalis*)
- English: leafy twig of oriental arborvitae, platycladus leaves
- Properties: bitter, astringent, slightly cold
- Channels: Lung, Liver, Large Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Cools blood, astringent and stops bleeding

Indications: widely used for various bleeding disorders including vomiting blood, bleeding gums, coughing blood, blood in the stool or urine, bloody dysenteric disorders and uterine bleeding.

- Coughing of blood, nosebleed, blood in urine, or heavy menstrual bleeding: Da Ji, Xiao Ji, Bai Mao Gen
- Bleeding due to deficient cold: Ai Ye, Pao Jiang
- Apply Ce Bai Ye powder topically for trauma injury leading bleeding.

Actions: Stops cough and dispels phlegm

Indications: for cough with profuse sputum due to accumulation of phlegm-heat. (new indication)

Actions: Treats hair loss, stops itching

Indication: topically use for treating seborrheid 脂溢性皮炎 alopecia. Soak fresh Ce Bai Ye in 60% alcohol for 7 days and apply the tincture to the scalp as an herbal wash.

Main Actions:

- Cools blood (astringent), stops bleeding
- Dispels phlegm, stops cough.

Dosage: 10-15 grams, maximum 30 grams. The unprocessed herb has a stronger function to cool the blood, while the charred form is better to stop bleeding.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Ce Bai Ye
- Herbs cool the blood and stop bleeding
- Herbs are astringent to stop bleeding
- What herb is used for treating alopecia?

Qiàn Cǎo 茜草

- *Radix Rubiae Cordifoliae*
- English: madder root, rubia root
- Properties: bitter, cold
- Channels: Liver

Actions and Indications

Actions: Cools the blood and stops bleeding

Indications: for vomiting blood, nosebleed, coughing blood, blood in the stool, uterine bleeding or any bleeding due to the reckless movement of hot blood.

Actions: Invigorates the blood and dispels stasis

Indications: for pain associated with blood stasis, amenorrhea, trauma injury, and Bi Syndrome.

Main Actions:

- Cools blood, stops bleeding
- Invigorates blood, disperses stasis

Dosage: 10-15 grams, with a maximum of 30 grams for herbal decoction.

- Chao (Toasted) Qian Cao cools blood and stops bleeding
- Sheng Qian Cao invigorates blood, disperses stasis, and stops bleeding

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Qian Cao
- Herbs invigorate the blood and stop bleeding
- Herbs cool the blood and stop bleeding
- What is the difference between Chao Qian Cao and Sheng Qian Cao?

Xiān Hè Cǎo 仙鹤草
“red-crowned crane plant”

- *Herba Agrimoniae Pilosae*
- English: agrimony
- Properties: bitter, acrid, neutral
- Channels: Lung, Liver, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Restrains the leakage of blood and stops bleeding

Indications: widely used for various types of bleeding, such as vomiting blood, coughing blood, nosebleeds, bleeding gums, blood in the urine, or uterine bleeding.

- Bleeding due to heat: Sheng Di, Mu Dan Pi, Zhi Zi, Ce Bai Ye
- Heavy menstrual bleeding due to deficiency cold: Dang Shen, Huang Qi, Pao Jiang

Actions: Alleviates diarrhea and dysenteric disorders, stops diarrhea

Indications: for chronic problems, as this herb has a restraining nature.

Actions: Kills parasites

Indications: for trichomonas vaginitis and tapeworm. Use 120 grams of this herb in a decoction and apply topically.

Main Actions:

- Astringent; stops bleeding
- Relieves diarrhea
- Kills parasites

Dosage: 10-15 grams in decoction. The maximum dosage is 30-60 grams. It may be taken internally or applied topically.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Xian He Cao
- Herbs are astringent to stop bleeding
- Herbs for treating chronic diarrhea
- Herb kills parasites for trichomonas.

Bái Jí 白芨
“white orchid”

- *Rhizoma Bletillae Striatae*
- English: bletilla, common bletilla tuber
- Properties: bitter, sweet, astringent, cool
- Channels: Lung, Stomach, Liver

Actions and Indications

Actions: Restrains the leakage of blood and stops bleeding

Indications: mainly for bleeding from the Lungs and Stomach, which includes vomiting blood, coughing blood, and nosebleeds

- Bai Ji is most effective for bleeding from the Lung and Stomach.
- Bai Ji can be used individually as a single herb.
- Take Bai Ji powder with rice congee or cold water.
- Use Pi Pa Ye, Ou Jie, Sheng Di, E Jiao to make juice or pills for dry cough with blood streaks.
- Coughing blood due to pulmonary tuberculosis: Bai Bu, Chuan Xin Lian

- Vomiting blood due to Stomach heat damaging the yin: Duan Shi Gao, Hai Piao Xiao, Mai Dong
- External bleeding due to cuts or injury; apply Bai Ji powder topically. It can also be combined with Duan Shi Gao

Actions: Reduces swelling and generates flesh

Indications: applied topically for sores, ulcers, and chapped skin

- Bai Ji is commonly used topically to treat sores and swellings with or without ulceration. It helps to close sores and wounds and promotes the generation of flesh.
- Early stage of carbuncles and sores: Jin Yin Hua, Tian Hua Fen, Bei Mu,
- Chronic non-healing wounds (ulcers) with pus: Use Bai Ji powder alone to promote healing.
- Burns or chapped skin on fingers or toes: Mix Bai Ji powder with sesame oil and apply topically.

Main Actions:

- Restrains the leakage of blood, stops bleeding
- Reduces swelling, promotes the generation of flesh.

Dosage: 3-10 grams in decoction, with a maximum dose of 30 grams. 1.5-3 grams of Bai Ji powder per dose.

Note: When treating internal bleeding, Bai Ji is not decocted with the other herbs, as its sticky nature will easily burn on the sides and bottom of the pot. Therefore, the powdered herb is usually mixed with the strained decoction.

Cautions:

Sticky and astringent in nature, Bai Ji should be used with caution in cases of coughing of blood caused by exterior infection, early-stage Lung abscess or excessive bleeding from the Lung or Stomach due to excess fire and toxin.

Note: Bai Ji is incompatible with Fu Zi and Wu Tou

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Bai Ji
- Which herbs are astringent to stop bleeding?
- Bai Ji is used to stop bleeding from which major organs?
- Which herb is topically used for chapped skin?

Ōu Jié 藕节

- *Nodus Nelumbinis Nuciferae Rhizomatis*
- English: node of the lotus rhizome
- Properties: sweet, astringent, neutral
- Channels: Lung, Stomach, Liver

Actions and Indications

Actions: Astringent, stops bleeding, and also invigorates blood.

Indications: used for various types of bleeding, especially vomiting or coughing blood, because it is both astringent and breaks up blood stasis: Bai Ji, Ce Bai Ye

Main Actions:

- Astringent
- Stops bleeding
- Secondly, it invigorates blood.

Dosage: 10-15 grams, with a maximum of 30 grams in a herbal decoction. The dosage for fresh Ou Jie is 30-60 grams.

- Sheng (unprocessed) herb stops bleeding and invigorates blood.
- Tan (charred) Ou Jie is astringent and stops bleeding.

Review questions:

- Actions and indications of Ou Jie
- What herbs are used for coughing and vomiting blood?
- What herbs are astringent and stop bleeding?
- What are the differences between sheng Ou Jie and Ou Jie Tan?

Pú Huáng 蒲黄 “cattail pollen”

- *Pollen Typhae*
- English: cattail pollen, bulrush
- Properties: sweet, neutral
- Channels: Liver, Heart

Actions and Indications

Actions: Retains blood and stops bleeding

Indications: for various forms of internal and external bleeding. It can be used alone and applied topically for traumatic injury.

Actions: Invigorates the blood and eliminates stasis

Indications: for chest pain, postpartum abdominal pain, and menstrual pain due to blood stasis.

Main Actions:

- Retains blood and stops bleeding
- Invigorates blood, eliminates stasis

Dosage: 3-10 grams in decoction. Wrap Pu Huang in cheesecloth during decoction. It may be used internally or topically.

Cautions:

Pu Huang is contraindicated during pregnancy, as it may stimulate uterine contractions
Pu Huang is contraindicated in the absence of blood stagnation

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Pu Hung
- What herbs stop bleeding without causing stagnation?
- What is the difference between sheng Pu Huang and charred Pu Huang?
- How should Pu Huang be treated when it is used in decoction?
- What are the cautions for Pu Huang?

Sān Qī 三七
“three-seven”

- *Radix Notoginseng*
- English: notoginseng or pseudoginseng root
- Properties: sweet, slightly bitter, warm
- Channels: Liver, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Stops bleeding and disperses blood stasis

Indications: for various types of internal and external bleeding, including vomiting blood, nosebleed, blood in the urine or stool, bleeding due to traumatic injury, etc.

San Qi has a unique ability to stop bleeding without causing blood stasis. It can be taken internally and applied topically. San Qi can be taken individually.

San Qi, Hua Rei Shi, Xue Yu Tang (Hua Xue Dan) invigorates blood stasis and stops bleeding.

Actions: Invigorates blood, disperses blood stasis, reduces swelling, and alleviates pain.

Indications: the herb of choice for traumatic injuries; used for swelling and pain due to falls, fractures, contusions, and sprains. In recent years, it has been used for coronary heart disease.

Main Actions:

Disperses blood stasis, stops bleeding

Invigorates blood, alleviates pain

Dosage: 3-10 grams in decoction, 1.0-1.5 grams per dose as powder.

In severe bleeding, the San Qi dosage is increased to 3-6 grams of powder orally, two to three times daily.

This herb is often used as powder or pills instead of a decoction.

Cautions:

Use San Qi with caution during pregnancy.

For bleeding conditions with yin deficiency and dry mouth, San Qi is combined with herbs that nourish yin and cool blood.

Use of San Qi may be associated with side effects: nausea, vomiting, loss of appetite, dizziness, headache, fatigue and restlessness.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of San Qi
- What herbs stop bleeding without causing blood stagnation?
- Which herbs are primarily used for treating traumatic injury?

Ai Ye 艾叶

- *Folium Artemisiae Argyi*
- English: artemisia argyi, argy wormwood leaf
- Properties: bitter, acrid, warm
- Channels: Spleen, Liver, Kidney

Actions and Indications

Actions: Warms the channels, stops bleeding

Indications: for prolonged menstrual bleeding and uterine bleeding due to cold and deficiency.

Ai Ye Tan is commonly used for:

- Profuse menstrual bleeding from deficiency and cold: E Jiao, Gan Jiang, (jiao ai tang)
- Irregular menses, cold sensation in the lower abdomen with severe cramps or possibly leucorrhea due to lower jiao deficient cold: Dang Gui, Xiang Fu

Actions: Dispels dampness

Indications: relieves itching due to eczema or other skin disorders-make an herbal wash.

Main Actions:

- Warms the channels, stops bleeding
- Disperses cold and alleviates pain

Dosage: 3-10 grams as herbal decoction. It is commonly used topically as an herbal wash or as moxa.

Cautions:

Warm and dry, Ai Ye should be used with caution for patients with yin deficiency or heat in the blood.